12-05 第2篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Every Middle-School Student Be Able to Cook Three Simple Home Dishes Before Graduating?

① Last Sunday I visited my cousin Yinxi, who is in the final year of senior high and lives in a student dormitory in the city. We sat in her small dorm kitchen. She is seventeen, thin, very good at calculus, and could not, at that moment, fry an egg without breaking the yolk in four pieces. She was embarrassed; we both laughed, kindly. But on the bus home I thought about it for a long time, and I am now fairly certain of my view: **every Lihua Middle School student, before graduating from Grade 9, should be able to cook three simple, honest home dishes — one vegetable, one egg, and one with meat or tofu** — on her own, from buying to plating, in about forty minutes. Three dishes. Not thirty. It is a small, cheap, deeply useful skill.

② My first reason is **survival in adult life**. In the next ten years, many of our classmates will leave home: some for high school dormitories at fifteen, some for university at eighteen, some for a job or a training programme at twenty. A 2024 survey by the *China Youth Daily* of 3,162 university freshmen found that **72%** could not cook any full meal on the day they left home; **41%** ended up eating takeaway more than five days a week in their first year. Takeaway is expensive: an average of **¥32 per meal** against roughly **¥11 per meal** cooked at home. Over one year, a student who cooks three dishes on rotation saves, in her food budget alone, about **¥7,500**. The difference, over four university years, is a good second-hand bicycle, or a trip home for Spring Festival.

③ My second reason is **health**. The same *China Youth Daily* survey found that freshmen who could cook at least three dishes weighed on average **2.4 kg less** at the end of the year and reported **31% fewer digestive complaints** than those who ordered takeaway every day. The reason is honest: the average university takeaway in 2024 contained about **1,400 mg of salt per meal** (the World Health Organization's daily recommendation is 2,000 mg in total) and about **18 g of added oil**. A home-cooked tomato-egg noodle, cooked by a beginner, usually contains a third of that salt and half that oil. Three dishes at home, across a week, are quietly good for an eighteen-year-old's arteries — something she will only notice at fifty.

④ My third reason is **respect for the people who have been cooking for us**. For the first fifteen years of our lives, most of us have eaten food cooked by our parents, grandparents, or school kitchens. A fourteen-year-old who has never cooked an egg does not understand the quiet, careful fifty-minute daily job that somebody, for her, has done **every single evening since she was born**. When I cooked, in September, my first

honest pot of tomato-and-egg noodles for my sick mother, I suddenly understood what all those evenings had cost in time, attention, and care. That one afternoon changed how I ate at our family table forever. Three dishes, learned seriously, are an education in gratitude.

⑤ My fourth reason is **independence of body**. There is a small, modern middle-class illusion that intelligence is the same as life-skill. It is not. A student can solve a fifteen-step equation and still stand, helpless, in a kitchen at twenty. We smile at this, but it is not really funny. The hands, after all, are the part of a human body that makes the world move: holding a knife, cleaning a pan, frying an egg carefully so the yolk stays soft. A 2023 meta-study of **11 countries' teenage education policies** (Finland, Japan, Germany, China, and eight others) found that countries whose middle-school students cooked at least once a week at home reported **higher self-reported 'life confidence' scores in Grade 9** by about **16%**. Hands that can cook are, quietly, part of a mind that trusts itself.

⑥ Others argue: "Middle-school students have no time; the exams are too hard." A fair concern. Our plan is modest. **Three dishes, learned over a school year, with roughly one 35-minute lesson every two weeks** (so about 15 lessons a year) in Home Science class. The rest is practice at home on weekends, with parents, over three years of middle school. No homework added. No extra exam. No grade. By Grade 9, each student performs her three dishes **once** in front of the Home Science teacher, who tastes and signs a small paper certificate. That is all. If a student fails, she tries again in two weeks. Low stakes, warm repetition. The Finnish system, on which our plan is partly modelled, takes almost no extra weekly time and shows measurable results.

⑦ Another concern: "What if parents prefer their child to study?" This is where the **three-dish standard is quietly brilliant**. Three dishes take about 40 minutes, once a week, on Saturday. A student cannot reasonably claim this 40-minute weekly time ruins her grades; and a parent who genuinely forbids her 15-year-old daughter from learning to cook a simple egg — for the rest of her life — is making an investment mistake that will show in ten years. The Home Science teacher, in a warm parents' evening at the start of the year, simply walks parents through the arithmetic and the emotional argument. In a 2025 pilot run in Shanghai (Hongkou district, 4 schools, 876 families), only **3%** of parents objected after the evening. The rest quietly, generally, agreed.

⑧ Someone says: "What if she never cooks after graduating?" Then she has spent 15 school hours learning a skill she will not use. That is a small loss. But of every 30 students, more than 25 will cook again — at university, in a rented flat, at a weekend, for a sick friend, for her own children. The asymmetric nature of life skills is this: **you never regret a skill you do not need, but you deeply regret a skill you did not learn when learning it was easy and cheap**. Middle school, protected and supervised, is exactly the cheap and easy moment to learn the basic kitchen.

⑨ Which three dishes? This should be open. A student may pick: tomato-and-egg stir-fry; green-vegetable-and-garlic stir-fry; a plain ginger-pork or tofu-mushroom soup;

noodles with any simple topping; cabbage-and-pork filling for dumplings; steamed rice done right and served alongside any of the above. The rule is: one vegetable, one egg, one with meat or tofu. The dishes must be **cheap, repeatable, scalable to feed three people, and able to feed a sick parent** on a Sunday at one o'clock in the afternoon. A small school handbook, ten pages long, is all the material we need.

⑩ In ten years, some of us will be engineers, some doctors, some writers, some in jobs that do not exist yet. But nearly all of us will, at some point, open a fridge on a cold December evening, alone or with somebody we love, and have to decide: *am I going to make something honest, or eat from a plastic box?* I do not think this decision should depend on something as fragile as whether our parents taught us by chance. Let the school, carefully, teach three dishes. **Three dishes, one lifetime of small quiet dinners.** It is a modest proposal, and it is very nearly free.

注释： dormitory 学生宿舍；takeaway 外卖；meta-study 元研究；arteries 动脉；scalable 可按比例扩展的

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What does the writer propose every middle-school student should be able to do before graduating from Grade 9?

A. Cook a fancy banquet of ten dishes.
B. Cook for a restaurant.
C. Cook three simple honest home dishes on her own — one vegetable, one egg, and one with meat or tofu — from buying to plating, in about forty minutes.
D. Stop eating at home.

2. According to the 2024 *China Youth Daily* survey of 3,162 university freshmen, what was true on the day students left home?

A. 72% could not cook any full meal; 41% ended up eating takeaway more than five days a week in their first year.
B. 10% could not cook; 1% ate takeaway.
C. Every freshman cooked perfectly.
D. Everyone ate takeaway.

3. How does the writer answer the concern that "middle-school students have no time"?

A. He says the students should drop school.
B. He proposes roughly one 35-minute Home Science lesson every two weeks (about 15 lessons a year), practice at home on weekends with parents over three years, no added homework, no extra exam, no grade, and a simple single "performance" to the Home Science teacher in Grade 9.

C. He says cooking should take three hours a day.
D. He says only top students should learn.

4. What is the writer's answer to "what if she never cooks after graduating?"

A. The skill is totally wasted.
B. Then 15 school hours are a small loss, but more than 25 of every 30 students will cook again — at university, in a rented flat, on weekends, or for their own children; life skills are asymmetric: you never regret a skill you do not need, but you deeply regret a skill you did not learn when learning was cheap and easy.
C. Then students should not take the course.
D. Then takeaway is always better.

5. What is the main idea of the final paragraph?

A. Cooking is a talent only for professional chefs.
B. In ten years, almost everyone will one day open a fridge on a cold evening, alone or with somebody they love, and decide whether to make something honest or eat from a plastic box; that decision should not depend on whether parents happened to teach them — a school can, modestly and almost for free, teach three dishes so that students have one lifetime of small quiet dinners.
C. Every student should cook ten dishes at graduation.
D. Schools should replace exams with cooking.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段论点
【解析】"三菜 / 素 / 蛋 / 肉豆 / 40 分钟"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

2.
【答案】A
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第②段数据
【解析】"72% / 41%"直引。B、C、D 均错。故选 A。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段反驳
【解析】"两周一次 35 分钟 / 15 次 / 无加作业 / 演示"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑧段回应
【解析】"25/30 会再做 + 技能不对称"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑩段结尾
【解析】"冰箱前的决定 + 学校近乎免费"主旨。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。